Dr. Christian König

Curriculum vitae

October 2026

Postdoctoral researcher at the WZB Berlin Social Science Center, Reichpietschufer 50, 10785 Berlin.
Phone: +49 30 25491 516; Email: christian.koenig@wzb.eu; Personal site: www.christiankoenig.org;
WZB site: www.wzb.eu/en/persons/christian-konig.

Current Position

01/2024–	*Postdoctoral Researcher* in the Research Unit on Skill Formation and Labor Markets (head: Heike Solga), WZB Berlin Social Science Center

Research Interests

Socio-spatial inequalities
Environmental and Climate Sociology
Urban Sociology
Education & Labor Markets
Quantitative Methods & Causal Inference

Previous Positions

2019–2023	*Doctoral Researcher* in the Research Group on Health and Social Inequality (head: Jan Paul Heisig), WZB Berlin Social Science Center
2019–2021	*Research Assistant* at the Cluster of Excellence "The Politics of Inequality" (supervisors: Guido Schwerdt, Stephan Maurer), University of Konstanz
2018	*Graduate Trainee* in the Directorate General for Innovation and Technology, European Parliament

Education

2024	PhD in Sociology (*summa cum laude*), Free University Berlin
	Dissertation title: "(Un)healthy Places: Causes, Patterns, and Consequences of Environmental Inequality in Urban Germany"
	Commission: Jan Paul Heisig (supervisor, reviewer), Rourke O'Brien (reviewer), Heike Solga, Martin Ehlert, Alessandro Ferrara
2019	M.Sc., Economics, University of Konstanz
	Thesis Title: "Do Voluntary Environmental Information Programs Affect Individual Transportation Choice?" (Supervisor: Stephan Maurer)
2016	B.A., Political Science and Economics, Eberhard Karls University Tübingen
	Thesis Title: "Stakeholders and Opportunities in German Fiscal Policy" (Supervisor: Daniel Buhr)

Research Stays Abroad

2021	*Visiting PhD Researcher*, Department of Sociology, University of Copenhagen
2017	*Visiting Graduate Student*, Department of Economics and Department of Environmental and Resource Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Administrative tasks

Committee Work

2020–	Department representative at the Academic Council, WZB Berlin Social Science Center
2026	Dahrendorf Fellowship selection committee, WZB Berlin Social Science Center
2025	Seed money funding selection committee, WZB Berlin Social Science Center
2020	Flexible funding selection committee, WZB Berlin Social Science Center

Organisation

2021	Organisation of Workshop on "Spatial analysis of social, environmental, and health inequalities", WZB Berlin Social Science Center
2020	Organisation of EAERE 2020 conference session (panel session on "Transportation and Environment")

Referee Work

Environmental Sociology, European Sociological Review, Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies, Population and Environment, Research in Social Stratification and Mobility, Social Forces, Social Science Research, Urban Studies

Memberships

ISA Research Committee 28 on "Social Stratification and Mobility", European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR)

Funds

2021	WZB Berlin Social Science Center seed money for an online survey experiment (10.500 EUR)
2019	WZB Berlin Social Science Center funds for data purchase (20.000 EUR)

Awards and Scholarships

2026	Peter A. Berger Dissertation Award (German Sociological Association, DGS)
2021	WZB World Merit Fellowship (6.200 EUR)
2017	Deutscher Akademischer Auslandsdienst (DAAD), PROMOS (2.800 EUR)

Journal publications

Nennstiel, R. and König, C. (2026) 'The thermostat of opportunity: Home air conditioning, its social gradient, and educational consequences', *Energy Research & Social Science*. Available (Open Access): https://doi.org/10.1016/j.erss.2026.104785

König, C., Salomo, K., Helbig, M. (2026) 'Understanding Variation in Neighborhood Environmental Inequalities: The Influence of Residential Segregation, Gentrification, and other City-Level Factors', *Urban Studies*. Available (Open Access): https://doi.org/10.1177/00420980251412793

König, C. (2024) 'Neighborhood structure and environmental quality: A fine-grained analysis of spatial inequalities in urban Germany', *Urban Studies*. Available (Open Access): https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/00420980231224224.

Books, chapters and reports

König, C., Heisig, J. P. (2023). Environmental Inequality and Health Outcomes over the Life Course. In R. Hoffmann (Ed.), *Handbook of Health Inequalities Across the Life Course*. Edward Elgar Publishing.

Heisig, J.P., König, C. and Solga, H. (2022a) 'Arbeit und Beschäftigung', in *Abschlussbericht Repräsentativbefragung zur Teilhabe von Menschen mit Behinderungen.* Bonn: Bundesministerium für Arbeit und Soziales.

Heisig, J.P., König, C. and Solga, H. (2022b) 'Bildung', in *Abschlussbericht Repräsentativbefragung zur Teilhabe von Menschen mit Behinderungen.* Bonn: Bundesministerium für Arbeit und Soziales.

Heisig, J.P., König, C. and Solga, H. (2022c) 'Ökonomische Situation und materielle Sicherheit', in *Abschlussbericht Repräsentativbefragung zur Teilhabe von Menschen mit Behinderungen.* Bonn: Bundesministerium für Arbeit und Soziales.

Heisig J. P., König C. (2021) Dicke Luft - Arme Haushalte und Menschen ohne deutschen Pass leben häufiger in Gegenden mit hoher Umweltbelastung. *WZB Mitteilungen*, Heft 173, September 2021: 16-19

Heisig J.P., König C., Löbl S. (2021) Ängste, Sorgen und psychische Gesundheit in der Corona-Pandemie. In: Badura B., Ducki A., Schröder H., Meyer M. (eds) Fehlzeiten-Report 2021. Fehlzeiten-Report, vol 2021. Springer, Berlin, Heidelberg. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-662-63722-7_8

Heisig, J. P. and König, C. (2020). Das Virus ist nicht demokratisch - Soziale Ungleichheit prägt den Verlauf der Infektion. *WZB Mitteilungen*, Heft 168, Juni 2020: 39-41.

Heisig, J. P. and König, C. (2020). Wie und warum die gesundheitlichen Folgen vom sozialen Status abhängen. *Corona und die gesellschaftlichen Folgen - Schlaglichter aus der WZB-Forschung.*

Work in progress

Consumption, Not Commutes: Explaining the Central Residential Concentration of Tertiary-Educated Individuals in Germany (*under review Social Science Research, with Sarah George, Marcel Helbig, and Sebastian Steinmetz*)

Where Is the City Center? How Computational Centrality Measures Shape Findings in Urban Inequality Research (*under review at Historical Social Research, with Sarah George, Marcel Helbig, and Sebastian Steinmetz*)

The Social Stratification of Luck: How the Consequences of Macroeconomic Conditions at Labor Market Entry Vary by Gender, Education, and Institutional Context (*with Thomas Biegert, Jan Paul Heisig, and Heike Solga*; working paper: https://doi.org/10.5281/ZENODO.15349521)

Environmental Quality, Local Infrastructures, and Residential Choice: A Survey Experiment on Ethnic Differences in Neighborhood Preferences (*with Jan Paul Heisig, Tobias Rüttenauer, Merlin Schaeffer, and Jonas Wiedner*)

Ethnic Differences in Environmental Quality and Educational Outcomes in Italy (*with Risto Conte Keivabu, Fabrizio Bernardi, and Jan Paul Heisig*)

Residential Environmental Quality and Health: Effect Heterogeneity by Socioeconomic Status and Migration Background

Presentations

[*] *Invited talks*

2026 ASSAf–Leopoldina Workshop on Climate Change and Mental Health, University of Pretoria[*]; ISA RC28 Spring Meeting, Pablo de Olavide University, Seville; Annual Conference of the DGS Section "Soziale Ungleichheit und Sozialstrukturanalyse", University of Potsdam

2025 ECSR Annual Conference, University of Cologne; Mapineq Annual Meeting, SOFI, Stockholm[*]

2024 Austrian Economic Association (NOEG) Annual Conference, BOKU Vienna; ISA RC28 Spring Meeting, NYU Shanghai; Workshop "Exploring the Role of Geography in Educational Inequality Research", UNED Madrid[*]

2023 ECSR Annual Conference, Institute of Sociology, Czech Academy of Sciences, Prague

2022 Workshop on Environmental Inequality in Europe and Beyond, TU Kaiserslautern; BSPS Conference, University of Winchester; Project closing conference "Umweltbelastungen und Umweltressourcen: Soziale Ungleichheiten und gesundheitliche Folgen", University of Göttingen[*]; ISA RC28 Spring Meeting, LSE

2021 Climate Talk, Center for Sustainability and Society (SUSY), University of Copenhagen[*]; ECSR Annual Conference (online); Research Seminar, Department of Sociology, University of Copenhagen[*]; ISA RC28 Spring Meeting, Turku (online); Virtual Inequality Brownbag, University of Michigan (online); Workshop "Spatial Analysis of Social, Environmental, and Health Inequalities", WZB Berlin Social Science Center (online)

2020 Workshop on Environmental Social Sciences, University of Bern (jointly organised with Nuffield College, Oxford); EAERE Annual Conference, Berlin (online); Public Economics Seminar, University of Konstanz[*]

Teaching

2026 Trends and determinants of Educational Inequality (MA seminar), Free University Berlin

2025 Introduction to causal research designs (MA seminar), Free University Berlin

2024 Mapping inequalities across the Life Course (MA seminar), Free University Berlin

2022 Inequality and Social Stratification (MA seminar), Free University Berlin

Media Appearances

Podcast/Interview, "Bekommt man mit einer Klimaanlage bessere Noten?", *Tonspur Wissen*, September 17, 2026.

(Background) Interview, quoted in "Die Wege des Virus", *Welt am Sonntag*, April 18, 2021.

(Background) Interview, quoted in "Dritte Welle: Besonders viele Migranten auf Intensivstationen?", *Faktenfuchs Bayerischer Rundfunk*, May 5, 2021.

Languages and Software

Languages	German (native), English (fluent), French (good), Spanish (good), Latinum
Software	R, LaTeX, Markdown, Git, MS Office, Python (basic), Stata (basic)

References

Jan Paul Heisig (WZB Berlin Social Science Center, Freie Universität Berlin)

Email: jan.heisig@wzb.eu

Heike Solga (WZB Berlin Social Science Center, Freie Universität Berlin)

Email: heike.solga@wzb.eu

Rourke O'Brien (Yale University)

Email: rourke.obrien@yale.edu

Tobias Rüttenauer (Goethe-University Frankfurt)

Email: ruettenauer@c3s.uni-frankfurt.de